



Same and Different

Quick facilitation notes & answer key

Goal

Children match a target to the card that is the SAME, then spot the one that is DIFFERENT. Comparing by attribute (same/different) is a core computational-thinking skill — recognizing equality is how computers find and group matching things.

Kindergarten frame (Ontario)

Problem Solving and Innovating — children compare and match objects by attribute as they make sense of their world.

No reading required of the child: read each prompt aloud; the child responds by circling.

Materials

The printed worksheet + a pencil/crayon. Optional: pairs of matching cards or objects to match by hand first.

Run it (about 15 min)

1. MODEL: hold up a circle. 'Find the one that is the same.' Point to the ● — that is the match.
2. GUIDED: do Exercise 1 together — the star matches the star.
3. YOU TRY: children do Exercise 2, then Exercise 3 (the odd one out) on their own.
4. Connect: 'Computers match too — that is how a phone finds the same face in your photos.'

Answer key (modelled by the run-gate)

Model — the ● matches Bit's ●.

Ex 1 — circle the ★ (the star). Ex 2 — circle the ■ (the square).

Ex 3 — circle the ▲; it is different because the other three are all circles.

Watch for & differentiate

Common slip: circling more than one — remind them there is exactly one match.

Simplify: match real identical objects by hand before using the page.

Extend: ask 'how is it different?' (shape, corners) to build describing language.

Movement option: hold up a card and have children point to or run to the matching card on the wall.

Success looks like

The child circles the one matching card for the targets, and identifies the single different card in Exercise 3.